Wednesday, February 22

According to some news outlets, Israel is about to attack Iran's nuclear installations. It could explain Netanyahu's rather passive behavior in the face of growing internal chaos: keep the coalition going until this crucial operation is over. A very dangerous but probably necessary gamble.

Three more bills passed first readings. The override law nullifies the Supreme Court's ability to declare laws unconstitutional. Another eliminates the court's ability to review political appointments. A third forbids hospitals to introduce hametz during Passover.

Whereas the third proposal simply demonstrates the power of ultrareligious parties in the coalition, the second would allow Deri's reinstatement. As for the first law, it puts an end to the influence of the Supreme Court in any controversy touching on fundamental issues, the guarantee of democratic rule.

In short, the coalition is rushing through this regime-changing overhaul, without showing any real readiness for compromise.

In a raid into Nablus and the firefight that followed, the army killed ten Palestinians and wounded about a hundred. These raids will not put an end to terror attacks; they only add to the violence.

Thursday, February 23

In the Knesset, a tempest of insults from all sides. Never have our so-called parliamentary debates been so violent and so disgusting! In the comments online, somebody wrote: "The face of the Knesset is like the face of the country." Unfortunately, this is correct, but the racist and anti-Arab insults come from one side only: the present coalition.

You won't believe it but, in the meantime, Netanyahu, and mainly Sara'le, his wife, have obtained state financing for two houses, a huge budget for clothes, and an unlimited budget for traveling. Sara'le has an